



THIS IS OUR DESTINY

SLUMDOG MILLIONAIRE / 2008

IN CONTEXT

GENRE

Drama

DIRECTOR

Danny Boyle

WRITERS

**Simon Beaufoy (screenplay);
Vikas Swarup (novel)**

STARS

**Dev Patel, Freida Pinto,
Madhur Mittal, Anil
Kapoor, Irrfan Khan**

BEFORE

1996 *Trainspotting*, a gritty black comedy based on the novel by Irvine Welsh, shoots Danny Boyle to fame.

2002 *City of God* shows the potential of dramas set in the developing world to have worldwide box-office appeal.

AFTER

2012 Boyle directs the 2012 London Olympics opening ceremony, including a Punjabi song composed by A. R. Rahman.

Set in Mumbai, *Slumdog Millionaire* tells the rags-to-riches story of a kid from the slums who tries his luck on a game show. The movie's influences are wildly cross-cultural. The source novel, Vikas Swarup's *Q&A*, was Indian, but the director Danny Boyle and screenwriter Simon Beaufoy are British. They present a Mumbai where traditional Indian and modern global influences are stirred together, backed by a sound track by A. R. Rahman that mixes Indian classical music with hip-hop and house, Bollywood, and R&B.

The story begins with Jamal Malik (Dev Patel), a penniless orphan from the slums of Mumbai, just one question away from winning 20 million rupees on Indian TV's "Who Wants to Be a Millionaire?" But when the show breaks before the crucial final question, he is arrested on suspicion of cheating—for how could a poor "slumdog" know all the answers? A cynical police inspector (Irrfan Khan) spends the night interrogating Jamal, who explains how his answers have been tied to events in his past.

Jamal (Dev Patel) and Latika (Freida Pinto) overcome adversity and prejudice to find love.

